FIN201 Personal Finance Basics - Course Syllabus

Office: Deskmate Demo Office

Term: 1st Semester 2026-2027

Course coordinator: Lourdes Abad

Syllabus version: 1

Course description

A practical course on managing money as an individual: planning cash, saving with a purpose, borrowing with care, and taking a first step into investing.

Learning outcomes

1. Prepare a monthly budget from real income and expenses.
2. Compute future value and present value for a single sum.
3. Compare loan offers using the effective annual rate.
4. Match simple investment choices to a goal and a time horizon.

Schedule

- Weeks 1 to 3: Chapter 1, Budgeting and Cash Flow. Quiz 1 is given on the Friday of week 3.
- Weeks 4 to 6: Chapter 2, Saving and the Time Value of Money. Quiz 2 is given on the Friday of week 6.
- Weeks 7 to 9: Chapter 3, Credit and Borrowing. Quiz 3 is given on the Friday of week 9.
- Weeks 10 to 12: Chapter 4, Starting to Invest. Quiz 4 is given on the Friday of week 12.

Grading

- Chapter quizzes (4): 40%
- Personal budget project: 20%
- Midterm examination: 20%
- Final examination: 20%

Required textbook

Money You Can Explain, 2nd sample edition, 2026, Deskmate Demo Press.

Course policies

- Each chapter quiz has a 20 minute limit and one attempt.
- A missed quiz may be taken within one week with a note from the coordinator.
- Quizzes are released by the office following the 'Release a quiz' process.
- Decks and readings for each chapter are filed in the office cabinet before the chapter begins.